

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior PM turning onboarding funnels into first trades.*

Positioning, I own activation end to end: funnel instrumentation, friction removal, and the path to a user's first "aha moment", backed by 13 years of product ownership in fintech, regulated software, and crypto.

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§ WHY KRAKEN

Kraken Pro serves traders who already know what they want, and still drops them. The gap between "account created" and "first trade placed" is a trust and clarity problem, not a marketing problem. Owning that funnel end to end, with access to real trade-flow data and a team that ships, is the kind of scope I actively look for. The explicit mandate to use AI to predict drop-off and personalize the onboarding path is the part I find most interesting, that is a measurably better product, not just a faster one. *That combination of data depth and activation scope is where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo prototyping and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, coding assistance across repos
- **Cursor**, AI-assisted code editing
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy UX flows
- **GPT**, research, drafts, edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

PostgreSQL, Python, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy, MongoDB, Django, Kotlin/Spring Boot.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, zero to one, built and run solo.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides of the hire until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, meets users where they already work.
 - LLM agents handle funnel automation so one person runs the full day-to-day operation.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, the same muscle Kraken Pro onboarding demands.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT KRAKEN

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the current onboarding funnel in the data, pull drop-off by step, segment by account type and market, and map every friction point against what the Pro team already knows.

WEEK 2

Instrument, slice, rank.

Define the funnel metrics that will track activation health, align on what "first trade" as the aha moment means in the data, and rank the top three highest-leverage interventions.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close loops.

Run the first targeted experiment on the biggest drop-off step, wire in the AI-assisted prediction layer for at-risk users, and set a weekly review cadence with Design, Data, Engineering, and Marketing.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Kraken team,

I have been a crypto user for over eight years. I actively trade spot and perpetuals across Kraken, Hyperliquid, Bitget, and several DEX venues, and I spend real time on market microstructure, liquidation heatmaps, routing quality, slippage analysis. That background shapes how I think about a Pro onboarding funnel: the users arriving there are not confused beginners, they are people with real intent who will leave the moment the product feels slower or less trustworthy than what they already use.

Activation and funnel work is where I have spent most of my career. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a roadmap that a five-person team could not deliver. I cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing workflows and the one the team had invested the most design effort in recorded exactly zero clicks, data over intuition, every time. Both situations required the same skill Kraken Pro needs: the ability to look at a funnel without attachment and act on what the numbers say rather than what the team hoped.

On the AI side, I use Claude Code, Copilot, Cursor, and n8n every day, for prototyping, for generating edge-case specs, and for building lightweight agentic workflows. For an onboarding funnel, that means faster iteration on personalization logic, quicker synthesis of qualitative signals from user interviews, and a tighter loop between "we think this is a friction point" and "here is the experiment result."

I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments product that ran inside the girocard ecosystem after acquisition by Sparkasse. Building and closing a fintech product taught me how users form trust with financial infrastructure and where they lose it, which is exactly the dynamic a Pro onboarding experience has to manage from the first screen.

I would welcome the chance to go deeper on how I would approach the first 90 days on the Pro onboarding funnel.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in fintech, regulated industries, and crypto. I run continuous discovery, define activation and funnel metrics, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe). I use AI tools daily to instrument funnels, generate prototypes, and move faster on data-backed decisions.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design. I instrumented two competing workflows and the UI-led one recorded exactly zero clicks.
- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and freed several QA hours every week.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Inherited a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver. Cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government. Secure data platform.

- Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

Wind energy. Full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare. Clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, zero to one: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- Quantum-secure encryption for enterprise buyers. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, funnel and activation metrics, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, data-driven prioritisation.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Lovable.

Crypto and Fintech: CEX and DEX trading, perpetuals, spot markets, P2P payments, PSP integration, stablecoins, girocard ecosystem, 8+ years active crypto user.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, agile release trains, PI planning.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube](#) (EN sample)

